

Some prefer a minimalist wardrobe filled with neutrals or bring the retro zing back to their lives. Similarly, the desktop environments available on your computer can help you do the same to your computer.

In this chapter, we'll give you a detailed introduction to desktop environments and how they work. Without further ado, let's get started.

What is a Desktop Environment?

Before we understand what a desktop environment is in a laptop or computer, let's try to understand how it works. You may or may not have heard about the kernel. If not, let me help you. The kernel is the brain of any operating system and in simple words, it is the operating system. The kernel is the direct mediator between the software and hardware of your computer and directly controls the hardware and makes the commands easy to read and interpret from the software. Likewise, it helps in the management of all hardware resources as well. It helps in creating a balance between both the hardware and software. It is also commonly known as the mediator and translator between your resources.

All the actions under the desktop environment are directly linked to the Graphical User Interface (GUI). It involves your icons, sidebar, mouse pointer, and everything in between. Basically it is concerned with everything that you can see with your eyes.

Before we proceed, let's understand what GUI is. That will help us gain some insights into the desktop environment.

What is Graphical User Interface (GUI)?

As the name suggests, it has everything to do with graphics or visuals. As stated earlier, the GUI is the way through which a user interacts with the operating system, with the help of visual indicators or representations. It makes browsing or accessing various features on the computer easier.



An open laptop with various icons and bars to choose from.